

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Sage Butter–Basted Chicken

with Rigatoni, Balsamic Tomato Sauce, and Mozzarella

Basting is a technique that involves spooning sauce or melted fat over meat repeatedly as it cooks to add flavor and lock in moisture. Here, we apply the method to skin-on chicken breasts, but with a twist: We add butter and whole sage leaves to the pan with chicken for richness and aromatic notes. The resulting crispy leaves make a delicious garnish for the finished plates of chicken, rigatoni, balsamic tomato sauce, and breadcrumbs.

35–45 minutes 1150 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 1 herb mix
  - ⅛ ounce sage
  - ⅛ ounce thyme
- 4 ounces fresh mozzarella
- 1 clove garlic
- 2 boneless skin-on chicken breasts
- 1 pint grape tomatoes
- 1 tablespoon balsamic vinegar
- 8 ounces rigatoni
- 2 tablespoons panko breadcrumbs
- 2 packets unsalted butter

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
8" medium pot
aluminum foil
baking sheet
12" large pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

The whole thyme sprigs seasoned the tomatoes with aromatic flavor during cooking, but won't be pleasant to bite into. We recommend discarding them before serving—any stray leaves that fell off during cooking will add extra flavor.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Preheat oven to 450°F. Bring a medium pot of water to a boil over high heat. Line a baking sheet with foil. Rinse all produce. Pick **sage** leaves, discarding stems. Roughly tear or cut **mozzarella** into 1-inch pieces. Mince **garlic**. Pat **chicken** very dry with paper towel (this will help the skin crisp up in the pan) and season all over with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired.



2. Roast balsamic tomatoes

On prepared baking sheet, toss **whole grape tomatoes** and **whole thyme sprigs** with **2 tablespoons olive oil**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper**. Roast until tomatoes have softened, 12–15 minutes (move on to Step 3—but don't forget to come back!). Then, using a fork, gently mash **tomatoes** on baking sheet to release their juices. Add **balsamic vinegar** and toss to coat. Continue roasting until sauce has thickened, 3–4 minutes more.



3. Cook rigatoni

While tomatoes roast, season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **rigatoni** and cook until al dente, about 11 minutes. Reserve **½ cup pasta cooking water**, then drain and return to pot, off heat. Meanwhile, heat **1 teaspoon olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **breadcrumbs**, **garlic**, **⅛ teaspoon salt**, and **pepper**. Cook, stirring frequently, until golden, 3–5 minutes. Transfer to a plate; wipe pan clean for the next step.



4. Cook chicken

Return pan from breadcrumbs to medium-high heat with **2 teaspoons olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **chicken** skin-side down; sear until skin is golden and easily lifts from pan, 5–7 minutes. Flip **chicken**, then add **butter**, **sage**, and **1 tablespoon olive oil** to pan. Cook, spooning over melted **sage butter** repeatedly, until chicken is cooked through and sage is crisp, 5–7 minutes more. Transfer **chicken** to a plate, skin-side up; set aside to rest. Reserve **sage butter** in pan, off heat.



5. Finish chicken and rigatoni

Once tomatoes are roasted, remove and discard **whole thyme sprigs** from baking sheet (see recipe tip). To pot with rigatoni, still off heat, add **balsamic tomatoes** and **half of mozzarella** and stir to combine. Adding 1 tablespoon at a time, stir in **reserved pasta cooking water** until sauce clings to pasta. Taste and add **salt** and **pepper** as desired.



6. Plate chicken

Cut rested **chicken** into ¼-inch slices. Divide **rigatoni with balsamic tomato sauce** between serving plates. Top with sliced **chicken** and drizzle over **sage butter** (and any crispy sage leaves in pan). Garnish with **garlic breadcrumbs** and **remaining mozzarella**. Dig in!

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